

features an easy-to-use antialiasing control user interface, and optimisations for Intel i815 and Pentium 4 processors and AMD Duron and Athlon processors. You can download them from www.nvidia.com/Products.nsf/htmlmedia/software_drivers.html.

Continuous beep on power up

Q I assembled a PC on my own, but whenever I power it up, I get a strange continuous beep and nothing shows on the monitor. Please explain why this happens.

// Accumulation of dust on the lens in the CD drive is the primary cause of read errors //

A Your video card is not fitted in right. Make sure the card connectors are snugly fitted in the respective slots, and see to it that the RAM and the processor are properly seated.

Linux incompatible

Q My graphics card doesn't work in Linux. How can I fix this?

A Make sure that your graphics card is supported under Linux, and that X-Windows is configured properly (just type **setup** in the console). If your graphics card is not supported, you should download the latest Xfree86-SVGA file, which is available at [ftp://rpmfind.net/linux/caldera/LTP/col/install/RPMS/XFree86-SVGA-3.3.6-6.i386.rpm](http://rpmfind.net/linux/caldera/LTP/col/install/RPMS/XFree86-SVGA-3.3.6-6.i386.rpm).

The latest version has support for most of the cards. However, if you find that your card is supported under Linux and it is still not detected, it means that you have not configured your X-Windows operating system properly. To do so, log in as root and at the terminal type **setup** and press [Enter]. Go to X configuration and press [Enter]. The Linux OS will either detect your card or ask you to configure it. If it does not detect your card, you can choose Custom. Now you would need to know your monitor's refresh rates, which can be obtained from the monitor's manual. If you can't determine the refresh rate, use a refresh rate of 60 Hz, which is supported by most monitors. Then, using a trial-and-error method you can find the best resolution for your PC.

Need for Speed doesn't work in Windows XP

Q I love playing racing simulations and have the entire *Need for Speed* series (2, 3, 4, 5) on CDs. But my problem is that none of my games work with Windows XP. What's the problem?

A The *Need for Speed* series does not natively support the Windows 2000/XP environment. But you can try using the program compatibility mode offered in Windows XP (right-click the Program file, go to Properties, and select Compatibility) and run the games in

Windows 98 mode. Now your games should work fine.

CD-ROM / DVD / CD-RW DRIVES

Long time detecting CD-ROM at startup

Q My computer takes a very long time searching for the CD-ROM during startup. How can I avoid this?

A You will have to make a few changes to your CMOS in order to solve this problem. Press 'Del' on startup; it will lead you to the CMOS. Choose the Standard CMOS option and select 'Auto Detect Hard Disk' and check whether the CD-ROM is set as slave to your hard drive. Now set the 'Primary Slave' option on 'Auto'. With the exception of hard disk and CD-ROM drive, set all other options of IDE device to none. Now save the configuration and exit by returning to the main setup.

CD tray behaves erratically

Q I experience a strange problem. Whenever I insert a CD in the CD tray, the CD tray comes out automatically after a while. Sometimes, it refuses to eject, while other times it refuses to go in. Please help me fix this erratic behaviour.

A This behaviour is often caused by dirty sense switch contacts or bad connections in the CD drive. Other reasons could be worn out or stretched belt of

the drive, poor or gummed up lubrication, defective motor or bad connections to the motor, stripped gear or other mechanical damage, defective micro-controller or other logic circuitry. Chances are that none of these problems can be fixed by you, nor are they easy to diagnose. Your best bet would be to get the drive and the system serviced/checked by an authorised service engineer.

A slow CD-ROM drive

Q When I insert a disk in my CD-ROM drive, the operations take too long to complete. For example, Windows Explorer takes a long time to show the contents of the disk. Sometimes, this simply fails and I end up rebooting the PC. Please help me fix this problem.

A If this problem occurs only with a single disk, chances are that this disk is dirty, scratched, or defective. If this problem occurs with most of the disks, then you could try cleaning the drive first, which could be dirty or have a damaged objective lens. If these two suggestions don't fix the problem, then there's a serious problem with the drive, such as a faulty sled motor or drive IC, faulty control logic, bad cables, faulty tracking or CLV servo, or an engaged transportation lock. In this case you will have to get the drive checked by a technician.

CDs don't autorun

Q My CDs do not autorun in my PC. However, the same CD autoruns on my friend's machine. How do I fix this?

A The problem occurs if there is an incorrect entry in the registry. Be careful while editing the registry, it's advisable to make a backup first. Go to **Start > Run**, type **regedit**, and click OK. Navigate to the following key: HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Policies\Explorer and modify the binary value for the NoDriveTypeAutoRun key to **0000 95 00 00 00**. This should take care of the problem.

Poor DVD playback

Q I have a problem with performance issues while playing DVDs on my DVD drive. The most common problem is a poor playback while playing any movie—even though the DVDs are of fine quality. Apart from this, I frequently come across